Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

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Hiring Manager
Technology Services, Enterprise Services & Operations
City of Toronto, Toronto, ON

Re: Spatial Specialist (Productivity and Automation Specialist), Job ID 66074

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Spatial Specialist (Productivity and Automation Specialist) position in Technology Services. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City, where much of my work is building and maintaining the spatial data the section relies on, so I would come to the enterprise geospatial team as one of its users.

I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets Transportation Planning depends on, using GIS and Python, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which combined several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from. Automating the routine parts of a geospatial workflow is how I approach a dataset.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. My master's thesis used GIS and macro-simulation to assess community transportation capacity for wildfire evacuation.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not administered ArcGIS Enterprise, written Arcade expressions, or used FME or Apache Airflow, and I have not prepared formal test plans for geospatial applications. My background is in transportation engineering rather than computer science or geomatics, though I am completing a part-time BSc in Computer Science at UBC.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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